

Digital cameras are hot!

At a time when PC and hand-held device purchases seem to be slowing down, one category of personal gadgets that is seeing promising growth is digital still cameras. Growth rates are being projected to be in the region of 50 per cent, despite high adoption rates in countries like the US. The major Japanese manufacturers, namely Sony, Olympus,

Fuji, Canon and others in the US like Eastman Kodak and Hewlett-Packard are all hoping that their products will capture the imagination of customers.

Major improvements in CCD resolution and lens technology have brought about a vast improvement in the image quality of the current generation of still cameras.

Apple switches to LCD displays

Apple has announced that it would now stop shipping CRT monitors with its professional systems and switch over to LCD displays. This would make them the first manufacturer to switch over completely to flat panel LCD displays for a major part of their product lineup. The iMac range, however, is likely to continue with CRT monitors for now.

With prices of LCD monitors coming down, partly due to an increase in volumes of LCDs being manufactured, these displays are likely to continue to become more affordable. IBM recently announced a new manufacturing process, which it claims would allow improvement in screen quality and viewing angles, and helps reduce the cost of production.

Redalert

Comically Yours

Attracting children to activate a virus is one strategy that cyber vandals seem to be taking into deep thought. Pikachu, a yellow rabbit-like character, which belongs to the Pokeman series of games, has shown his happy face to many of the computer users in the US and faithfully deleted their system files also. This little brat has been quite a big menace. The virus researchers from Symantec say that they have never, until now seen a virus targeted at children. In fact, this is one of the first viruses targeted at children as the little Pokeman attracts children and makes them double-click him. The e-mail

appears with a title, 'Pikachu Pokemon' and an English message, "Pikachu is your friend".

Pikachu has been spreading very slowly and has given enough time for researchers to put updates with their packs. Despite the fact that the virus has spread slowly, it has had heavy impact on the victims. It deletes the windows and system directories. The OS from the Redmond giant has to be installed from scratch and since it happens to be on most desktops all over the world, it's indeed a heavy impact on PC users. Trend Micro from Japan has warned Japanese people to delete any mail with such a message.

quicktake

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On e-publishing, an area where it is now making an entry

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▲ What is the future of e-publishing and eBooks in India?

E-publishing hasn't taken off in India because of the copyright problem. Online book publishing and online books will never take off without an offline model supporting it. Fur-

thermore, you would never be comfortable reading large volumes of text off your screen.

And again, it would be costlier for you to take a printout of the eBook. So to make the e-publishing and eBooks a success, a lot of work needs to be done to improve computer displays so that there is less eye strain.



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MD
IDG Books India

Sulfnbk.exe

A hoax e-mail warning people of a virus, which would be triggered on June 1, was on the prowl for sometime recently. The message stated that your computer might be infected with virus and it asked you to check for a file by the name sulfnbk.exe.

The message added that the virus is not detectable by any of the anti-virus software and that it could be safely deleted by searching it with the Microsoft Find File tool.

People who received the e-mail were astonished to find that the file actually exists in their computer in the Windows directory.

In reality it's a Microsoft file, which is used by the OS to resolve long file names.

The file is harmless and what's more, deleting this system file would make the feature of resolving long file names inactive.

Alarmed by its contents, everyone tried to help their friends, spreading the hoax.

All this started with a virus named W32.Magistr.24876@mm, which infected the file sulfnbk.exe. It was curable with any of the available anti-virus software. The first victim thought that the infected file was the virus and started spreading the message that sulfnbk.exe was a virus.



◆ Norton lays off 10,000 workers ◆ MP3 format gets upgraded to MP3Pro ◆ Mail bug hits NTT DoCoMo mobile users in Japan